

Euclidian space of n dimensions, $i_1, i_2, \dots, i_n$. These are such that all the ordinary laws of algebra except the commutative law of multiplication apply to the general integral expression q , called a multenion, where

$$q = \sum (x_0 + x_1 i_1 + x_2 i_2 + \dots)(x'_0 + x'_1 i'_1 + x'_2 i'_2 + \dots) \dots, \quad (1)$$

where every x is a scalar. Since any x may be negative we understand this statement to include the ordinary algebraic uses of the signs $+$ and $-$; but we do not understand that any assertion has been made about the use of the sign $\div$ [$q \div r$ can later be understood to be an alternative for qr^{-1}].

LAW II. Scalars are commutative not only with each other but with each of the n primitive unit vectors. [Thus scalars are commutative with multenions.]

LAW III. [i_1^2 means $i_1 i_1$, etc.]

$$-1 = i_1^2 = i_2^2 = \dots = i_n^2.$$

LAW IV. In a product, called a primitive vectorium, $i_a i_b \dots$, of primitive unit vectors, if two adjacent *different* vectors be interchanged, the product merely changes sign.

Such are the assumptions. The rest is development, aided of course by suitable terminology and symbolisation.

DEF. 1. A primitive unit means any one of the following: (1) the scalar 1, (2) any primitive unit vector i_a , (3) any other primitive vectorium $i_a i_b \dots$ [Strictly (3) includes (2) and in a sense (1).]

DEF. 2. An expression of the form

$$p = \sum_{c=1}^n x_c i_c$$

where each x is a scalar, is called a vector, or a V_1 or a $_n V_1$.

DEF. 3. Any multenion is obviously capable of expression in the form $\sum x i_a i_b \dots i_k$ where $i_a, i_b, \dots, i_k$ are m different primitive vectors and m ranges from 0 to n , m being given $V_m q$ means the sum of all parts of the multenion for that value of m . Thus

$$q = V_0 q + V_1 q + V_2 q + \dots + V_n q.$$

$V_a q$ is said to be the part of q of homogeneity a and is called a V_a or a $_n V_a$ or a homogeneous multenion or a hyper vector. [These alternatives are intended to invite suggestions for a settlement of the name. I should have preferred "an a -vector" but this clashes with relativity meanings of 4-vector and 6-vector. In multenions with $n = 4$, there are two kinds of 4-vector $_4 V_1$ and $_4 V_3$.]

$V_0 q$ will generally in words be called the scalar part of q but in the present connection we must not use Sq as an alternative for $V_0 q$. In applications we very decidedly need to be able, in one system of multenions ($n = 4$) to make

no change in the quaternion notation but yet to use both the quaternion notation and the full multenion notation as applying to one symbol q . Thus

$$Sq = V_0q + V_4q, \quad Vq = V_2q.$$

Endless confusion would result from allowing V_0 to be represented by S .

DEF. 4. If $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_a$ are any a -vectors then $V_a\alpha_1\alpha_2\dots\alpha_a$ is called a vectorium. [Hence we have already called such an expression as $i_1i_2i_3$ a primitive vectorium.]

DEF. 5. A linear multenion function of a multenion is called a multenion linity. Similarly for a vector linity or a $_nV_a$ linity, etc. An extended vector linity is a special kind of multenion linity, Φ , defined from a given vector linity, ϕ . Its fundamental property is this: If $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_a$ are any a -vectors whatever, a itself ranging from 0 to n , then

$$\Phi V_a\alpha_1\alpha_2\dots\alpha_a = V_a\phi\alpha_1\phi\alpha_2\dots\phi\alpha_a. \quad (2)$$

[It is not obvious that this remark covers a possibility in general. The definition, which will be modified below, is given here as a hint of the importance of vectoriums and extended linities in our subject.]

Usual Notations.

Scalars (V_0): $a, b, c, g, h, k, l, m, n, t$ (= time), $x, y, z, \mathfrak{J}$ ($=\sqrt{-1}$), θ (= arc), π .

General multenions: p, q, r, s .

Hyper vectors (homog. mult.) and vectoriums:

Homogeneities	V_a	V_b	V_c	V_n	V_2
Hyper vectors	u	v	w	xv	ω
Vectoriums	$\check{\alpha}$	$\check{\epsilon}$	$\check{\eta}$	$x\check{v}$	$\check{\omega}$

(These conventions should be noted and remembered. They immensely simplify the reading of formulae by their property of minimising number of suffixes, etc.)

Vectors (V_1): $\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \zeta, \xi, \eta, \lambda, \mu, \nu, \rho, \sigma, \tau$.

Linear functions: $\xi, \eta, \lambda, \mu, \nu, \omega, \nu, \phi, \chi, \psi$.

Vectoriums: $\check{\alpha}, \check{\epsilon}, \check{\eta}, \check{\iota}, \check{\sigma}, \check{\beta}, \check{v}, \check{\omega}$.

Differential symbols: $\delta, \Delta, H, L, d, d_\rho, d_{\check{\rho}b}, d_{s\alpha}, d\alpha, d\check{b}$.

Selective linities, etc.: K, P, Q, R, S, T, U, V.

DEF. 6. Complexes of vectors, hypervectors, multenions, etc., are sufficiently illustrated by multenions. If $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_a$ are a given multenions, then all multenions of the form $\sum_{c=1}^a x_c q_c$ are said to form a complex. If $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_a$

can be made linearly dependent on b and no fewer, then b is called the complexity of the complex. Thus the complexity of the complex of all vectors is n , of all multenions it is 2^n , of all multenions of homogeneity a it is ${}_nC_a$.

DEF. 7. A unit vector or a unit vectorium is one, $\check{a}$, such that $\check{a}^2 = \pm 1$. [The square of every vectorium is a scalar, but u^2 is a scalar in general only in the four cases when $a = 0, 1, n-1$ or n .] Thus all the primitive vectoriums are unit vectoriums.

DEF. 8. Two vectors, α, β , are said to be normal to one another when $V_0\alpha\beta = 0$. Two vector complexes are said to be completely normal to one another when every vector of the one complex is normal to every vector of the other.

Every one of the symbols V_a is a multenion linity. They are all commutative with one another. They are all idempotent, that is $V_a^2 = V_a$, and they all satisfy the equation $V_aV_b = 0$ when $a \neq b$.

There is another system of multenion linities of great utility and simplicity. They are 2^n in number. They are all commutative with each other and with each of the $n+1$ linities V_a . Let P_a be that definite linity of a general multenion, q , which simply reverses the sign of every i_a which occurs in the expression (1) for q . From the well-known properties of linities a product of the P 's such as $P_1P_2P_3$ simply reverses the sign of every i_1, i_2 , and i_3 . These linities are (1) unipotent, that is, if

$$\phi = P_aP_b \cdots P_k, \quad (3)$$

then $\phi^2 = 1$; (2) they are proscriptive, by which is meant that

$$\phi(qr) = \phi q \phi r, \quad (4)$$

where q and r are any two multenions. It is convenient to use P for the product $P_1P_2 \cdots P_n$ of all the linities P_a , so that P reverses the sign of every primitive vector.

K is defined, consistently with its quaternion use, in the following manner. Kq is a linity of a general multenion, q , which reverses the sequence of the primitive unit vectors in every primitive vectorium $\check{l}$, of q , and *also* reverses the sign of every primitive unit vector. Thus $K(i_1i_2i_3) = (-i_3)(-i_2)(-i_1) = i_1i_2i_3$. K is (1) unipotent, that is $K^2 = 1$; (2) it is commutative with every V and every P ; (3) it is retrospective, that is $K(qr) = KrKq$. [To prove (3) first prove it when q and r are two primitive vectoriums and then generalise. Such a method of proof is very often applicable and may be referred to as proof by reduction to primitive units.]

$$K(qr) = KrKq. \quad (5)$$

but if ϕ be given by (4), $K\phi (= \phi K)$ is also retrospective. More generally, if $\phi, \psi, \chi, \dots$ are any number of multenion linities, every one of which is either proscriptive or retrospective, then also is the product, $\phi\psi\chi\dots$, proscriptive or retrospective; it is proscriptive when the number of $\phi, \psi, \chi, \dots$ which are retrospective is even, and it is retrospective when that number is odd.

The special retrospective $PK (= KP)$ is of sufficient importance to have a symbol appropriated to it. We shall call it Q . Thus the product of any two of the three P, Q, K is equal to the third.

A caution to users of present methods in relativity and hyperbolic geometry seems desirable. It relates to the discussion of real questions by aid of the imagery

$$\mathfrak{J} = \sqrt{-1}. \quad (6)$$

Let us illustrate by anticipating our mode of treatment of real questions in relativity. We begin with the multenion system based on the primitive generators i_1, i_2, i_3, i_4 . Then we put

$$i_4 = \mathfrak{J}t, \quad (7)$$

and drop out of most of our subsequent work all reference to the original i_4 and $\mathfrak{J}$, using t instead with its property $t^2 = 1$, as opposed to $i_4^2 = -1$. Questions in relativity are then treated by aid of the multiplicative combinations of such expressions as

$$xi_1 + yi_2 + zi_3 + tt. \quad (8)$$

whereby, so long as all the scalars thereby introduced are real, we shall be dealing with real questions in relativity. The general multenion thus constructed contains 16 and not 32 independent real scalars. t is for practical relativity purposes real. We shall call such a multenion system semi-real.

Now return to the meaning above assigned to K .

$$\begin{aligned} K(i_1 i_2 i_3 i_4) &= i_1 i_2 i_3 i_4, \\ \text{and also } K(i_1 i_2 i_3 t) &= i_1 i_2 i_3 t, \\ \text{but whereas } K'(i_1 i_2 i_3 i_4) &= (i_1 i_2 i_3 i_4)^{-1}. \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

it is not true that the corresponding equation holds when we replace i_4 by t . I have therefore refrained from making the definition of K depend on such equations as (9). It is, nevertheless, a perfectly easy theorem to prove that

$$Kt = t^{-1}. \quad (10)$$

when t is any product of our *original* generators $i_1, i_2, \dots, i_n$. This ceases to be true when t takes the place of i_4 , simply because $\mathfrak{J}^{-1}$ is $-\mathfrak{J}$ and not $+\mathfrak{J}$. It may be noted, however, that there is always a reproscriptive $K\phi = R$ to be found, which is such that for every semi-real vectorium $\check{i}$, $R\check{i} = \check{i}^{-1}$.

Thus, suppose we replace $i_{a+1}, \dots, i_n$ by $i'_{a+1}, \dots, i'_n$, where

$$i'_c = \mathfrak{J}i_c \quad \text{and therefore} \quad i_c^2 = 1, \quad c = a+1, a+2, \dots, n. \quad (11)$$

Then

$$R = KP_{a+1}P_{a+2} \cdots P_n = QP_1P_2 \cdots P_a, \quad (12)$$

is easily shown to have the required characteristic. We now obviously have

$$P = P_1P_2 \cdots P_n, \quad (13)$$

$$Pu = (-1)^a u, \quad Qu = (-1)^{\frac{1}{2}a(a-1)} u, \quad Ku = (-1)^{\frac{1}{2}a(a+1)} u. \quad (14)$$

Further if we put

$$q_c = V_c q, \quad c = 0, 1, \dots, n, \quad (15)$$

$$\begin{aligned} Pq &= q_0 - q_1 + q_2 - q_3 + \cdots, \\ P_{(0)}q &= \frac{1}{2}(1+P)q = q_0 + q_2 + q_4 + \cdots, \\ P_{(1)}q &= \frac{1}{2}(1-P)q = q_1 + q_3 + q_5 + \cdots, \end{aligned} \quad (16)$$

$$Qq = q_0 + q_1 - q_2 - q_3 + q_4 + q_5 - \cdots, \quad (17)$$

$$Kq = q_0 - q_1 - q_2 + q_3 + q_4 - q_5 - \cdots. \quad (18)$$

Clearly, we might introduce $Q_{(0)}$, $Q_{(1)}$, and $K_{(0)}$, $K_{(1)}$, corresponding to $P_{(0)}$ and $P_{(1)}$. All the linities recently considered (V_c , ϕ , $K\phi$) may be referred to as the capital linities.

§2. THEOREM OF INDEPENDENCE AND ALLIED ALGEBRAIC FEATURES.—If $q_1q_2 = -q_2q_1$, then q_1 and q_2 are said to be anti-commutative. In the following enunciation, a product of a different multenions from among $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_m$ is said to be odd-formed or even-formed, according as a is odd or even.

If $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_m$ be m multenions such that $q_1^2, q_2^2, \dots, q_m^2$ are all scalars differing from zero, and each pair is anti-commutative; then, if m is even, the 2^m multiplicative combinations are linearly independent; and, if m is odd, they are independent unless the product $q_1q_2 \dots q_m$ of all of them is a scalar; and, if it is a scalar, 2^{m-1} and only 2^{m-1} of the combinations are independent, and these 2^{m-1} independent combinations may be taken as the odd-formed combinations, or instead as the even-formed combinations, or instead as the combinations from which one assigned multenion, such as q_m , is absent. The theorem is true of linities as well as of multenions.

Thus, if n is even, a general multenion cannot be expressed by fewer than 2^n independent scalars. In the case of $n = 4$, it cannot be expressed by fewer than sixteen independent scalars. In the case of $n = 3$, it can be expressed by four independent scalars, the same number as in the case of $n = 2$. [But to express it thus, we have to impose the condition that $i_1i_2i_3$ is a scalar such as -1 . This is practically Hamilton's procedure in Quaternions.] Either of these cases might be regarded as the case of